

[← Back to Archive](#)

OCTOBER 5, 2026

The new AI risk is dependence, not just cheating

Fresh research and this week's policy signals point to a sharper agenda for schools: protect student thinking, design AI around learning, and make assessment evidence harder to outsource.

 Listen · 5:50

1

Top story

CHINA · RESEARCH

A 1,029-student study maps two routes into AI dependence

A new study of 1,029 Chinese high school and university students argues that generative AI dependence is not one behavior but two pathways: deep cognitive absorption and a more utilitarian habit of using AI because it reduces effort. The research, summarized by [BIOENGINEER](#), applies the I-PACE behavioral-addiction model to student AI use.

That matters for schools because the remedies differ. A student mesmerized by chatbot interaction may need attention-management routines; a student using AI as an academic shortcut may need tasks that rebuild the value of independent effort.

“

The next integrity problem is not only whether AI wrote the answer. It is whether students are losing the habit of doing the thinking before the tool arrives.

Evidence is converging on cognitive work

Psychological literacy joins AI literacy

The student-dependence study links overreliance to cognitive absorption and perceived usefulness, suggesting AI guidance should teach learners how their own attention and motivation respond to tools. [BIOENGINEER](#).

Educators feel ready, but training is uneven

An IBM/Morning Consult survey reported by Education Week found 83% of educators confident teaching about AI, while many still learn through social media, friends, or family rather than formal professional development. [Education Week](#).

Learning science warns against cognitive offloading

Microsoft's education principles emphasize AI that supports learning rather than replacing student thinking, with age-appropriate controls and scaffolded practice. [Microsoft](#).

Nordic signals still center on teacher control

🇳🇴 **NORWAY** Norwegian debate continues to focus on teacher control and age-appropriate use after reports that AI tools are already used in nearly three-fourths of primary/lower-secondary schools and over 90% of upper-secondary schools. [VG](#).

🇳🇴 **NORWAY** Bodo remains Norway's only municipality in the European AI Academy project, where schools and Nord University are testing curriculum, tools, and teacher networks for responsible classroom AI. [NRK](#).

🇫🇮 **FINLAND** Finland's Generation AI project is still a useful Nordic reference point after UNESCO recognized it for curriculum-scale AI-in-education work rather than one-off tool adoption. [Gulf Digital News](#).

Assessment, skills, and career readiness are tightening

🇰🇪 KENYA KNEC warned teachers not to use AI to complete or assist learners' School-Based Assessment tasks, clarifying that the concern is assessed evidence, not a blanket technology ban. [Education News Kenya](#).

🇻🇳 VIETNAM Vietnam National University, Hanoi and Google launched AI Arena: Viet Nam 2026, a national generative-AI competition where university teams build proof-of-concept prototypes with Gemini and AI Studio. [Vietnam News](#).

🇮🇳 INDIA Kakatiya University announced reforms including an AI-enabled curriculum, stronger industry links, and international research pathways for students in North Telangana. [Hindu Dayashankar](#).

🇦🇪 UAE Alef Education is positioning responsible, AI-powered learning as a showcase theme at Ai Everything Abu Dhabi 2026, keeping safety and personalization together in the edtech pitch. [Emirates News Agency on MSN](#).

🇺🇸 US EDUCAUSE 2026 closed with AI reportedly topping higher education's IT priority list for the first time, displacing cybersecurity as the headline planning issue. [Tech Times on MSN](#).

🇮🇳 INDIA Nearly 70 Delhi middle-school students used robotics, coding, IoT, and automation in the MBD AI STEAM Championship, showing AI literacy as team-based practice. [The Hindu](#).

Platforms are selling safeguards and practice

Microsoft sets a school privacy and safety bar

Microsoft says its education AI approach includes privacy and safety standards, human oversight for consequential decisions, age-appropriate controls, and educator-centered product design.

[Microsoft](#)

Google backs a national student build challenge

AI Arena gives Vietnamese university students structured access to Gemini and AI Studio, then scores teams on feasibility, vision, and creativity.

[Vietnam News](#)

Alef leans into responsible personalization

The UAE edtech company is using a major AI event to show responsible AI-powered learning, reflecting how vendors now pair personalization claims with trust language.

[Emirates News Agency on MSN](#)

What to watch next

Assessment rules will get more specific

Kenya's SBA warning shows the emerging distinction: AI may support teaching, but it cannot produce the evidence used to score a learner.

AI literacy may absorb well-being literacy

If dependence pathways hold up, schools will need to teach attention, effort, and self-monitoring alongside prompts and tool mechanics.

Higher education is moving from experiments to budgets

When AI tops institutional IT priorities, the question shifts from pilots to governance, procurement, security, and measurable value.

AI in Education Digest · Berit Herstad · October 5, 2026 · Compiled from public sources

[!\[\]\(d3fb9f94af8b26d1c844efa9a98805b0_img.jpg\) Download PDF](#)